

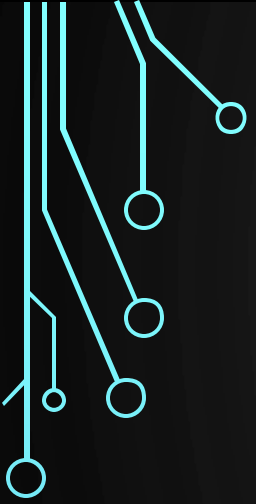


Power Up Your Career Through Community and Public Learning

Jim Jones

@koolaidIT

<https://koolaid.info>



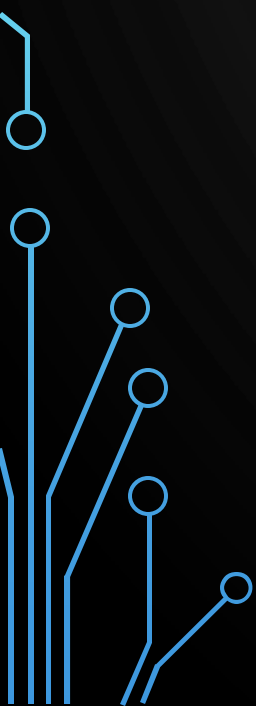
Agenda

01 What is public learning

02 Tech community 101

03 Why should I care?

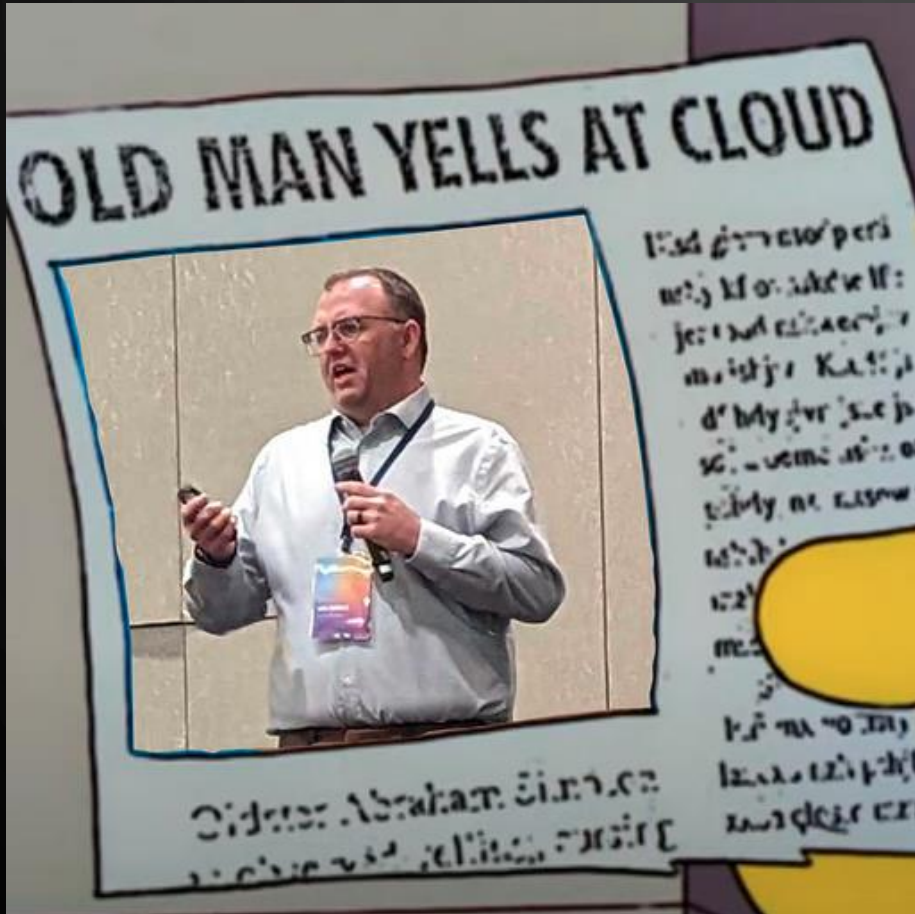
04 Getting started



The Challenge

- Post to social media with original thoughts about this presentation
- Tag @securewv with #PublicLearning
- 5 random posters will win prizes (AWS credits!) via DM after the session

About Me



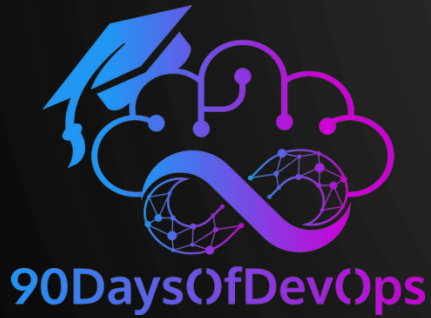
- Product Architect = Frankenstein Lab Nerd
- @k00laidIT for socials
- <https://koolaid.info>
- Mountwest (AAS), Marshall (BA), Maryland (MS)
- Certs from Veeam, Cohesity, VMware, Cisco, AWS, Microsoft
- Veeam Vanguard, VMware vExpert, AWS Community Builder, Object First Aces

What Is Public Learning?

- Willingness to put your ideas out for consumption, challenge and evolution
- A mindset, not a look at me
- Idea of reinforcing what you learn by formatting it for others
- Excuse to be collaborative — invite others to participate in your learning

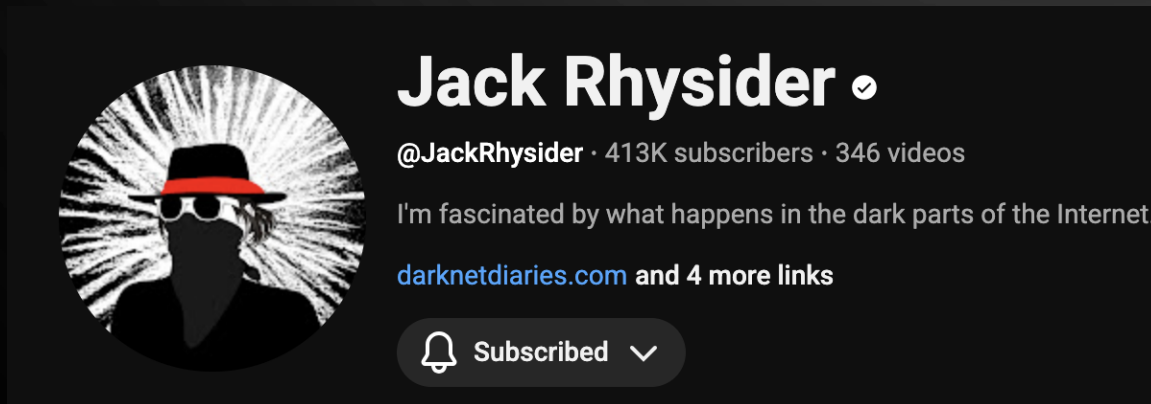


What Is Public Learning?



Examples:

- Blogs
- YouTube/Twitch
- Github
- Conference speaking
- Social media



Tech Community 101

- Congrats, you are in it!
- Different things to different people
 - Social media interaction
 - Attending conferences or user groups
 - Discords/Slacks
 - Vendor Programs
- Public learning but with other people
- Goal is to grow your skills by growing your network

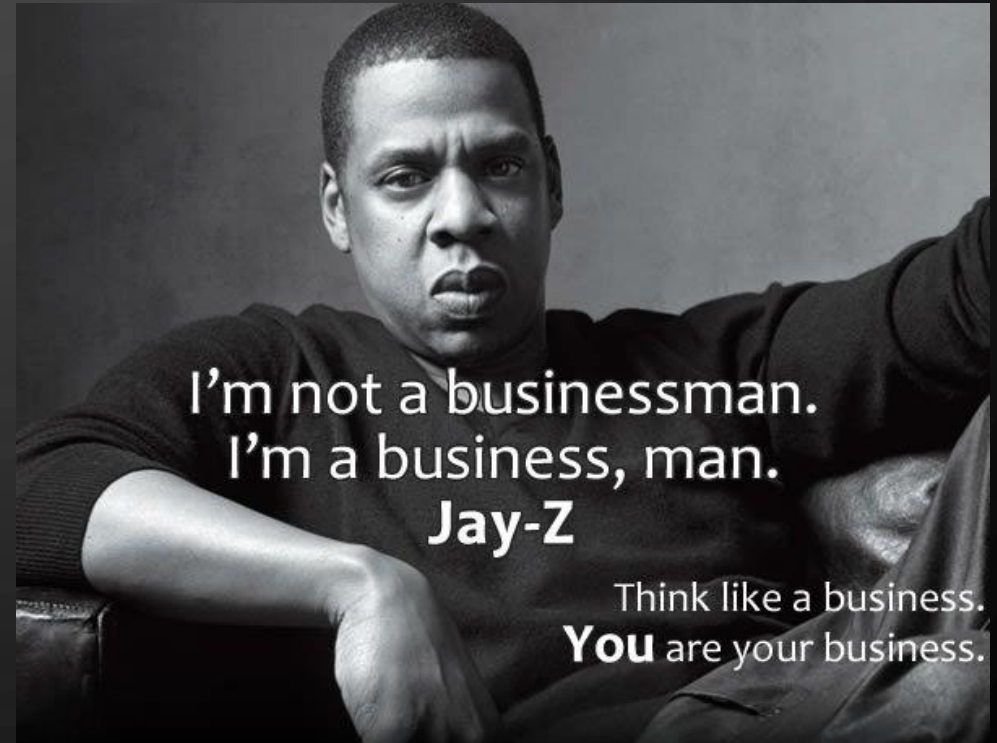


The background is a dark gray gradient with a large, faint, light gray circle centered in the upper half. Four stylized, light blue circuit-like lines with small circles at their ends are positioned in the corners: top-left, top-right, bottom-left, and bottom-right.

Why Should I Care?

Professional Growth

- If you are the smartest person in the room, it's time to find a new room
- Learn to talk the walk
- Ability to learn from others at scale
- Find new topics to consider, new ways to do things



Fringe Benefits

- Travel
- Public speaking and other soft skills
- Gear, Software, Services
- Swag
- Friends



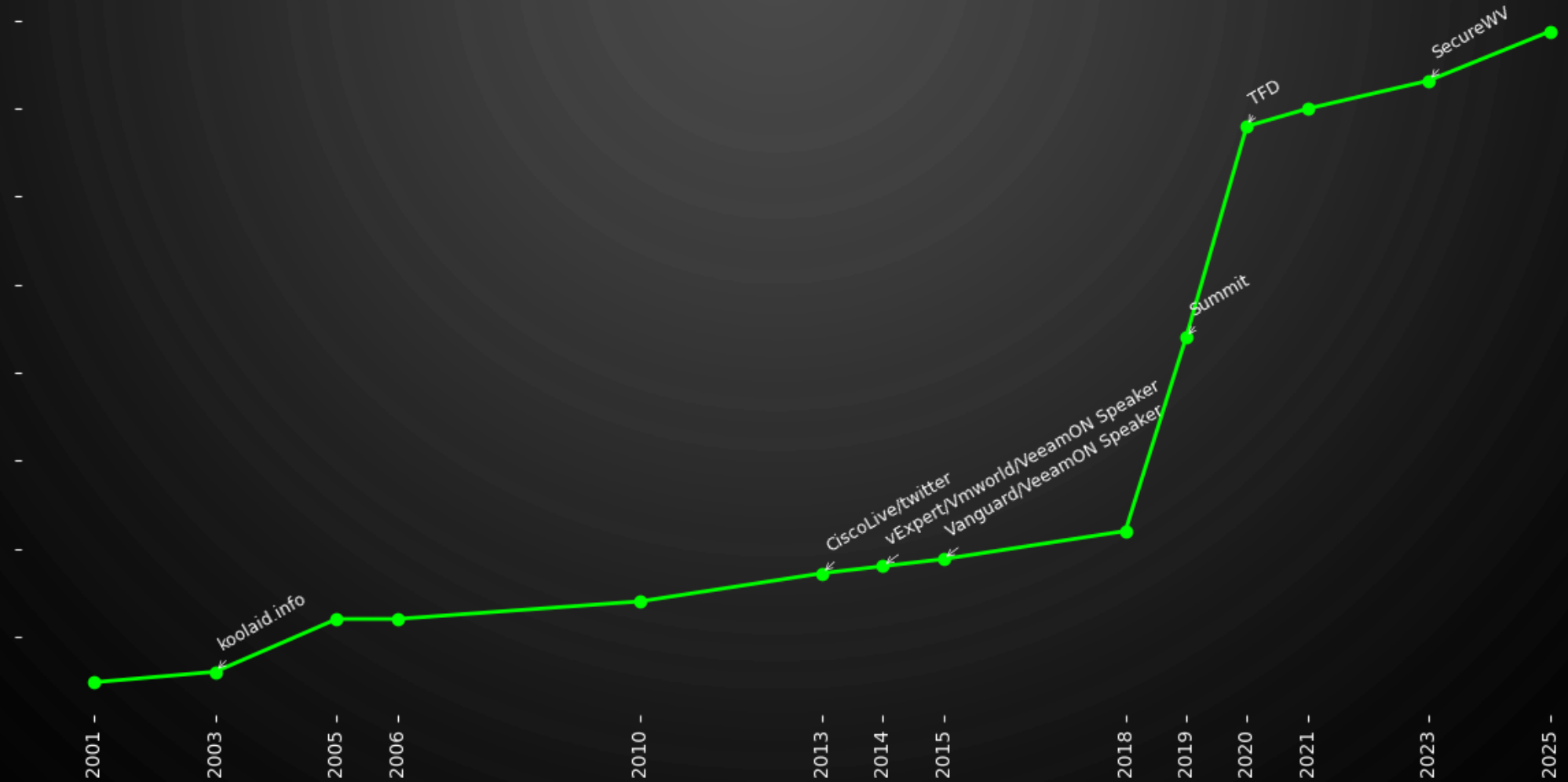
Welcome!

Set up your Synology DS923+ now!

Install



Career Growth



The image features a dark gray background with a subtle pattern of concentric circles. In the four corners, there are decorative white line art elements resembling circuit boards or neural network connections, with small circles at the end of the lines.

Getting Started

1. Put Yourself Out There

- Be part of (or around) the conversation
- Be open to different viewpoints
- No such thing as bad or repetitive content
- Follow what interests you, passion speaks volumes!



Discover your Brand

- What's your thing?
 - Figure out your niche to describe yourself
 - Don't be afraid to overdo it
 - Can be as simple as "I am learning as I go"
- What to do:
 - Be yourself, be positive
 - "Dress for the job you want"
- What not to do:
 - Be crude or harmful
 - Be toxic



Lock It Down

- Look for domain/socials/etc. first!
- Focus on what will matter to you
- Don't be afraid to do variants
- Lean on tools like Zapier to unify



What Works For You

- Remove Friction!
- Do you like code?
- Video, Blogging?
- Speaking in person or on streams?
- Don't be afraid to change it up



Q & A

Jim Jones | @k00laidIT | <https://koolaid.info>

Session Info: <https://talks.koolaid.info>

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Thank You